

Redmi Note 12 5G

Recipe for success

The Redmi Note 12 5G is the first smartphone from Xiaomi in 2023. The latest budget offering from the company has been launched with many new features and a new design that brings it in-line with the current design language for Redmi smartphones. We have been using the Redmi Note 12 5G for this review for about two weeks now and we finally have enough data to give you a verdict about how the smartphone performs. Let's take a look.

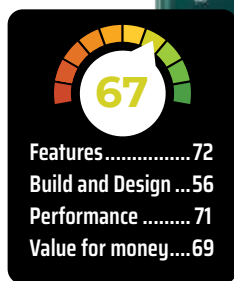
DESIGN

The Redmi Note 12 5G now falls under the Xiaomi sub-brand's new design language, with the rectangular camera module placed on the top left corner of the back panel. The Redmi Note 12 5G is very lightweight, coming in at only 188 grams. The back panel is polycarbonate with a glass-like finish. We got an olive green shade for our review, which gives the smartphone a premium and classy look. There is a slight chin on the bottom of the screen, but that is negligible. Overall, it is a safe design approach from Xiaomi, and the smartphone looks nothing out of the ordinary. In terms of size as well, the Redmi Note 12 5G is not too big, but those who prefer smaller phones will look elsewhere.

DISPLAY

The display on the Redmi Note 12 Pro is good. Xiaomi has managed to provide a 120Hz AMOLED display with a 394 ppi pixel density and a 240Hz touch response rate. Now, this is a sharp display which is extremely responsive. The AMOLED panel ensures a certain level of colour accuracy, and watching videos or movies on this display is a treat.

The Redmi Note 12 5G's display is also super bright, with a claimed peak brightness of 1,200 nits. This display is good for using in all kinds of environments



and the sunlight visibility is pretty good on this display. According to our lux meter test, the Redmi Note 12 5G put out a maximum brightness of 816 nits.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, this is where Xiaomi must be hoping that the Redmi Note 12 5G blows the competition out of the water. The Redmi Note 12 5G is the first Xiaomi smartphone in India to come with the new Snapdragon 4 Gen 1 budget chipset. However, the performance figures of the Redmi Note 12 5G aren't the best in this segment. The Redmi Note 12 5G's most recent competitor, the Realme 10 Pro 5G performed better than the latest "Super Note" in almost all benchmarks that we ran on the device. However, there were certain tasks and usage scenarios where the Redmi Note 12 5G beat the Realme 10 Pro 5G by a margin. Another caveat here is that the Redmi Note 12 5G faced issues in running certain benchmarks like 3D Mark, GFXBench, and more that give an idea about the smartphone's GPU performance. We are not sure if Xiaomi has blocked these benchmark tests, but it makes it tricky to get an idea of the smartphone's performance.

While gaming, the Redmi Note 12 5G was able to put up a good performance.

The smartphone was able to run games like Call of Duty Mobile on a high frame rate, which is great for a budget offering. In terms of software, MIUI is not the most refined Android skin, especially if a user is coming from a cleaner, more user-friendly UI.

BATTERY

In the power efficiency game, the Redmi Note 12 5G came out right at the top. The battery efficiency on this new chip is marvelous. The Redmi Note 12 5G only lost about 5 percent of battery life with a 15-minute Call of Duty: Mobile gaming session and lost 12 percent battery during one hour of GPS navigation. Otherwise also, the smartphone was easily able to give us close to 7 hours of on-screen time.

CAMERA

The Redmi Note 12 5G comes with a triple rear camera setup. The camera on the Redmi Note 12 5G is pretty good. The images are nice and sharp, with the details remaining intact in most scenarios. The colours are saturated at times. In low light conditions, the details are slightly hazy and the Redmi Note 12 5G messes up the shadows in non-ideal lighting conditions. However, in bright outdoors or any well-lit situations, this camera works very well.

VERDICT

So that was the Redmi Note 12 5G. The Redmi Note 12 5G offers a lot of things its rivals don't. However, the smartphone lagged behind many rivals in terms of performance figures. Still, the Redmi Note 12 5G delivers on the value-for-money factor just like its predecessors, with the inclusion of 5G connectivity and a nice AMOLED display. And while the performance is not top-notch, it is perfectly serviceable.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Weight: 188 g | Display: 6.67-inch Super AMOLED | Display resolution: 1080x2400 | Refresh rate: 120 Hz | IP Rating: IP53 | Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 4 Gen 1 | RAM: 8 GB | ROM: 128 GB | Software: MIUI 13 | Camera (rear): 48 + 8 + 2 MP | Camera (selfie): 13 MP | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Fast charging: 33W

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